

ABDELAZIZ DARWESH

IT & Cybersecurity Researcher

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Computer Science and IT graduate with hands-on experience in cybersecurity research, network security, and technical support. Skilled in vulnerability assessment, digital forensics, and secure web development using Python, PHP, and JavaScript. Track record of hardening systems, reducing attack surface, and responsibly disclosing vulnerabilities to major platforms including TikTok, Instagram, Facebook, Marsool, and Microsoft.

CORE SKILLS

Cybersecurity: Vulnerability Assessment, Penetration Testing, Ethical Hacking, Digital Forensics, OWASP Top 10, YARA Rules, Kali Linux, Wireshark, Nmap, IPTables, CIS Benchmarks, Incident Response

IT & Networking: Troubleshooting, System Administration, Networking Fundamentals, Windows & Linux Administration

Development: HTML, CSS, JavaScript, PHP, Python, React, React Native, Supabase, MySQL, Git/GitHub

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Cybersecurity Intern — *Zadip Group, Riyadh, Saudi Arabia* Jun 2023 – Aug 2023

- Monitored network traffic and endpoint activity in real time, identifying and escalating 15+ potential security incidents to strengthen incident response capability.
- Authored 10+ custom YARA rules to detect malware and hardened system configurations against CIS benchmarks.
- Hardened 25+ Linux servers using IPTables firewall rules aligned to CIS benchmarks, cutting the vulnerability score by 60%.

Security Researcher — Independent Bug Bounty Hunter — *Multiple Platforms (HackerOne)* 2022 – Present

- Identified and responsibly disclosed security vulnerabilities across major platforms including TikTok, Instagram, Facebook, Marsool, and Microsoft, with reports triaged and remediated by each platform's security team.
- Discovered a privilege escalation vulnerability in TikTok's content management system; built 5 proof-of-concept attack vectors and had it validated and patched within 72 hours of disclosure.
- Applied OWASP-recommended testing methodology across engagements, helping reduce potential attack surface by up to 40% on assessed applications.
- Ranked 30th out of 32,000+ participants worldwide on CyberTalents for cybersecurity skills and challenge performance.

Freelance Web & App Developer — *Remote / Self-Employed* Jan 2024 – Present

- Programmed 5 responsive company websites and built 3 web/mobile applications — including apps for restaurant clients — using HTML, CSS, JavaScript, PHP, and Python, ensuring cross-browser compatibility and W3C compliance.
- Built secure user authentication systems, contact forms, and API integrations following secure coding standards; provided ongoing technical support.

EDUCATION

B.Sc. Computer Science & B.Sc. Information Technology <i>Eastern Mediterranean University, Famagusta, Northern Cyprus</i>	2025
Diploma of Network Engineering <i>Alfaisal International Academy, Riyadh, Saudi Arabia</i>	2017

CERTIFICATIONS

CompTIA Security+ • CEHv9 • ICSI Certified Network Security Specialist • Microsoft Security Operations Analyst (2024) • AWS Cloud Essentials (2024) • Google Cybersecurity Fundamentals • Security Cloud • IBM SkillsBuild: Threat Intelligence & Hunting, Cybersecurity Fundamentals (2025)

LANGUAGES

Arabic (Native) • English (Fluent) • Turkish (Limited Working Proficiency)